DETAILS MATTER
Mitra's work proudly displayed and specially commissioned for Galeries Lafayette in an iconic Mumbai building (below and right)





nique is a chameleon," he explains. "It can look international or it can feel deeply local." Hidden within the sharp, contemporary folds are abstracted references to the lotus and the conch shell. These aren't obvious motifs; they are Easter eggs for the observant viewer. You see the architecture of the fold first, and then, as you linger, the Indian soul reveals itself.

Shopfronts to Sanctuaries

For 15 years, Mitra has been on a mission to blow up origami, to take it off the coffee table and turn it into a spatial experience. "I want you to walk through the geometry, not just look at a folded bird," he says. While the Galeries Lafayette project is a public wow moment, Mitra is increasingly bringing this sculptural language into the private home. However, the energy shifts when moving from a storefront to a living room. In a retail space, the paper must perform; in a home, it must breathe. "In a residence, it's about the inhabitant's personality," Mitra notes. For an extroverted homeowner who hosts often, the installation might be a bold, jostling ceiling that mimics the energy of a city street. For others, it's a tool for intimacy—a textured wall in a quiet nook designed for meditation and shadow-play.

Folding Your Own Space

Bringing origami architecture into a home is a blend of art commission and structural renovation. Mitra's work typically begins in intimate 8x8-foot zones, yoga rooms or reading nooks where folded material envelopes the occupant to help the mind expand. For those looking for a grander statement, the work scales into double-height lounges where the ceiling becomes a folded skyscape.

As for the cost, custom lighting pieces or smaller, intimate installations typically start around ₹4 lakh to ₹5 lakh. Large-scale spatial interventions for lounges and entertainment zones scale upwards based on complexity and material, often reaching into the high double digits as they transform from decor into permanent architectural art.

By transforming humble folds into monumental architecture, Mitra (now 45) has proved that the ancient art of origami is no longer confined to a tabletop, it is a living, breathing language that can be translated into any material. All you need is the right vision.